

Chapter 25 — Qal–Niphal Contrast Drill (Weak Roots)

BBH Chapter 25 · Niphal Weak Verbs

Each item gives a weak root with its Qal meaning, a Niphal form, conjugation, and reference. For each: (1) translate the Niphal form; (2) name the semantic function: Passive / Reflexive / Simple Action / Stative. (3) explain in one sentence how the Niphal meaning follows from the Qal. Answer key at the bottom.

Part A — I-■ Roots

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
1			יָפַל		
2			נָגַשׁ		
3			הִגָּד		
4			נָגַע		
5			יָנַח		

Part B — III-■ Roots

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
6			נָגְלָה		
7			נָעְלָה		
8			נִרְאָה		
9			יָבְנָה		
10			נָעֲשָׂה		

Part C — Hollow Roots

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
11			נִקְוָם		
12			נִכְוֵן		
13			יִשָּׁם		
14			נִבְוָא		
15			נִשְׁוָב		

Answer Key — Part A

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
1			יָפַל		
✓	Root	Qal Meaning		Conj	he fell — Simple Action I-נ Niphal imperfect:
2			נִגַּשׁ		
✓					he approached — Simple Action Niphal of
3			הִגִּיד		
✓					to be told — Passive הִגִּיד is Niphal inf.
4			נִגַּע		
✓					he was touched — Passive subject receives
5			יִנָּכֶה		
✓					he shall be struck — Passive Exo 21:20 legal

Answer Key — Part B

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
6			נִגְלָה		
✓					it was revealed — Passive or Reflexive Gen
7			נִבְעַלָּה		
✓					he went up — Simple Action Niphal of הלע
8			נִרְאָה		
✓					he appeared — Passive/Reflexive Gen 12:7:
9			יִבְנֶה		
✓					it will be built — Passive dagesh forte in בּ +
10			נַעֲשָׂה		
✓					what has been done — Passive Gen 20:9;

Answer Key — Part C

#	Root	Qal Meaning	Niphal Form	Conj	Ref
11			נָקַדְם		
✓					it was established — Passive Niphal of נָקַד;
12			נָכוֹן		
✓					it is firm — Stative Niphal Psa 103:19: "his
13			יָשַׁם		
✓					it will be placed — Passive Niphal imperfect
14			נָבֹא		
✓					we went / came — Simple Action Num 32:9;
15			נָשׁוּב		
✓					it was brought back — Passive or SA Niphal